IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 1

Daily Life

Routines, habits and talking about your day

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 1 · Book pp. 10–19

LEARNING GOAL

Describe daily routines clearly and accurately in speech and writing

Objectives: you will…

- use daily-routine collocations and tell the time
- use the present simple with adverbs of frequency
- find information across several short texts
- work out new words from context
- complete a form while listening
- write a paragraph about a routine
- give extended Part 1 speaking answers

Success criteria: I can…

- use routine phrases and say clock times correctly
- put frequency adverbs in the right place
- add -s / -es for he, she and it
- say which words in a text prove my answer
- spell names and write numbers correctly
- order my paragraph with time words
- add a reason or example to each answer

IELTS STRATEGIES

Three test habits to build in this unit

READING

Information is often in more than one text. Check every text and choose the one that answers **completely**.

Practise: Reading slides and Part C

LISTENING

The answer may use **different words** from the ones you hear. Listen for the meaning, not just the same words.

Practise: Listening slide and Part D

SPEAKING

Plan with **short words or phrases**, not full sentences. Reading full sentences aloud loses marks.

Practise: Speaking slides and Part F

LEAD-IN

A school day, hour by hour

06:30
get up

07:00
have breakfast

07:20
catch the bus

15:30
do sport

17:00
do homework

22:30
go to bed

Talk to a partner

Which times are the same for you? Write 3 more activities you do every day, then ask: “What time do you…?”

VOCABULARY

Routine collocations: verb + noun

have	go	do	catch / take	get
breakfast	to school	homework	the bus	up
a shower	online	exercise	a train	dressed
lunch	to bed	the housework	a taxi	home
a break	shopping	sport	the skytrain	ready

Learn words in pairs. We say *do homework*, not *make homework*, and *go to bed*, not *go to the bed*.

VOCABULARY

Telling the time

Digital	In words
07:00	seven o’clock
07:15	quarter past seven
07:30	half past seven
07:45	quarter to eight
08:10	ten past eight
08:50	ten to nine

past

1 to 30 minutes **after** the hour

to

31 to 59 minutes: count the minutes **before** the next hour

You can also say the numbers: 07:45 = “seven forty-five”.

GRAMMAR

The present simple

Form

	I / you / we / they	he / she / it
+	I walk to school.	She walk**s** to school.
–	I **don’t** walk.	She **doesn’t** walk.
?	**Do** you walk?	**Does** she walk?

After *doesn’t* and *does*, the verb has no -s.

Use it for…

routines and habits

I get up at 6:30 every day.

facts

The library opens at 8.

timetables

The bus leaves at 7:20.

GRAMMAR

Adverbs of frequency: how often?

0%	≈10%	≈50%	≈70%	≈90%	100%
never	**rarely**	**sometimes**	**often**	**usually**	**always**

Before the main verb

She **usually** walks to school.

I **don’t often** watch TV.

After the verb be

He is **never** late.

We are **always** tired on Mondays.

GRAMMAR

He, she, it: spelling and common mistakes

Spelling rules

Rule	Example
most verbs + s	play → plays
-ch, -sh, -s, -x, -o + es	watch → watches
consonant + y → ies	study → studies
irregular	have → has

Fix the mistake

Not: She go to school by bus.

Say: She goes to school by bus.

Not: I go always to bed at 11.

Say: I always go to bed at 11.

Not: He doesn’t plays tennis.

Say: He doesn’t play tennis.

READING · IELTS STRATEGY

Matching information across several texts

In IELTS Reading you often read short texts and decide **which text** contains a piece of information. The words in the question are usually **different** from the words in the text.

1

Read the question first. Underline the key idea.

2

Think of other words with the same meaning.

3

Check every text. Some include a similar idea that does not fully match.

4

Choose the text that matches completely, and find the proof.

READING PRACTICE

Three students, three routines

A · Mei, Bangkok

School starts early, so I get up at six. I usually take the skytrain and eat breakfast on the way. I have piano lessons twice a week.

B · Omar, Dubai

My lessons finish at 2:30. It is very hot in the afternoon, so I often play football with my cousins after sunset. I rarely watch TV.

C · Lena, Berlin

I cycle to school every day, even in winter. I never eat at home in the morning. On weekdays I go to bed at about ten.

Which student…

1 travels to school without using an engine?
2 does sport when the weather is cooler?
3 has a regular activity two times a week?

READING SKILL

Guessing meaning from context

> “Omar’s lessons finish early, so he has plenty of leisure time for football and seeing friends.”

Word type

It describes “time”, so it works like an adjective.

Nearby words

“football”, “seeing friends”: fun activities.

Linking words

“so” shows a result of finishing early.

Test it

Replace it: “free time”. Does the sentence still make sense?

LISTENING · IELTS PART 1

Form completion

Before you listen

Read the form. Predict each answer: a name, a number, a date or a place?

IELTS STRATEGY

The answer may use **different words** with the same meaning. You may also hear something that is **not** the answer.

After you listen

Check the word limit and your spelling. Capital letters for names.

Student Exchange: Registration

Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER

Family name: **1** _____

Age: **2** _____

Host city: **3** _____

Arrival date: **4** _____ July

Stays with: a host family

WRITING

Describing a daily routine

1
Topic sentence
What is your day like?

2
Morning
getting up, travel

3
Afternoon
school, clubs, sport

4
Evening
homework, free time

5
Closing
How do you feel about it?

Time order words

First, … · Then, … · After that, … · Later, … · Finally, …

Time expressions

at 7 o’clock · in the morning · on weekdays · at weekends · twice a week

WRITING · MODEL

What does a good paragraph look like?

My weekdays are busy but organised. I **usually** get up at 6:15 and have a quick shower. Then I have breakfast with my family and catch the school bus at 7:00. Lessons start at 7:45 and finish at 3:30. After that, I **often** stay at school for basketball practice. I get home at about 5:30 and do my homework before dinner. In the evening, I **sometimes** chat with friends online, but I **never** stay up late. Finally, I go to bed at 10:30 because I need lots of energy for the next day.

Notice

A clear topic sentence

Underlined: time order words

Bold: adverbs of frequency

A reason with “because”

About 100 words

SPEAKING · IELTS PART 1

Talking about familiar topics

What happens

4–5 minutes

The examiner asks short questions about you: home, studies, routines, free time.

IELTS STRATEGY

Plan with short words or phrases, not full sentences. Reading full sentences aloud loses marks.

- What do you usually do in the morning?
- How do you get to school?
- Do you prefer weekdays or weekends? Why?
- Would you like to change anything about your routine?

SPEAKING STRATEGY

Extend your answer: A + R + E

Answer

Answer the question directly.

Reason

Say why: because..., so...

Example

Add detail: for example..., like...

“How do you get to school?”

TOO SHORT By bus.

EXTENDED I usually take the school bus, **because** it’s cheaper than a taxi. The journey takes about 40 minutes, so I often listen to music, **for example** K-pop or film soundtracks.

PAIR PRACTICE

Interview your partner about their day

Speaker

Answer 4 Part 1 questions with A + R + E.

Listener

Tick: frequency adverb? reason? example? correct -s?

Then

Swap roles. Report one fact: “Sam usually…”

REVIEW

Can you…?

- Name 8 routine collocations
- Use he / she / it + -s correctly
- Put always, often, never in the right place
- Say which words in a text prove your answer
- Guess a new word from context
- Write an ordered paragraph about your day

Next: take the *Unit 1 Challenge* on Miss L Gems and submit your PDF on Google Classroom.